

Koalacademy: A Music Production Curriculum Using Koala Sampler

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Koalacademy is a comprehensive music production curriculum designed for urban school districts. This course is intended for students interested in learning how to produce music using Koala Sampler, an intuitive and user-friendly music production application that can be used on iOS devices. The curriculum is designed to guide students from beginner to advanced levels of proficiency over the course of 20 weeks.

Throughout the course, students will explore various aspects of music production, including sound design, sampling, sequencing, mixing, and effects processing. Additionally, students will learn basic music theory concepts and how to apply them in their music production using Koala Sampler.

Unit Structure:

1. Music Theory and Koala Sampler Navigation

- Component 1: Basic Music Theory
 - Intervals, scales, chords, and basic harmony
 - Key signatures, time signatures, and rhythm
- Component 2: Koala Sampler Navigation
 - Interface and workflow
 - Loading and manipulating samples
 - Sequencing and arranging

2. Understanding Sampling and Digital Drumming/Drum Design

- Component 1: Understanding Sampling
 - Sampling as a practice
 - Notable works from producers such as Timbaland, Kanye West, Pharrell Williams, and others
- Component 2: Digital Drumming/Drum Design
 - Types of drum sounds and how they are used
 - Modifying drum sounds using effects and processing

3. Song Forms in Popular Music and Rights/Permissions Pertaining to Sampling

- Component 1: Song Forms in Popular Music
 - AABA form and simple variations

- Analyzing popular songs for their structure
- Component 2: Rights/Permissions Pertaining to Sampling
 - Ethical use of sampling
 - Paths to get clearances for samples for official works

4. Defining Your Sound and Artist Appreciation Week

- Component 1: Defining Your Sound
 - Creating a playlist of 10 songs that represent their style of music
 - Musical analysis of each song in the playlist using tools learned in previous units
- Component 2: Artist Appreciation Week
 - Choosing 3 songs from their playlist to sample in a final Koala project for the course
 - Presenting each of the three songs to the class

5. Advanced Effects Processing and Performing with Koala Sampler

- Component 1: Advanced Effects Processing
 - Deeper exploration of the Perform Tab in Koala Sampler
 - Creative use of effects to expand on ideas
- Component 2: Performing with Koala Sampler
 - Live recording arrangement patterns and songs using tools and practices learned in previous units

Koalacademy is a cutting-edge music production curriculum that offers students a hands-on learning experience with an industry-standard music production tool. By the end of the course, students will have a comprehensive understanding of music production and the skills needed to produce their own music using Koala Sampler.

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Unit 1 • Component 1

BASIC MUSIC THEORY

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BMT.1 - BASIC MUSIC THEORY

The basics of music theory are essential for any aspiring musician or music producer. Understanding the 7 natural notes and how they form a major scale is a fundamental concept that lays the groundwork for further study in music theory.

The 7 natural notes in Western music are A, B, C, D, E, F, and G. These notes can be arranged to form a major scale, which consists of 7 notes arranged in a specific pattern of whole steps and half steps. The pattern for a major scale is: whole, whole, half, whole, whole, whole, half. For example, the C Major scale consists of the notes C, D, E, F, G, A, and B, with the pattern of whole steps and half steps as follows: whole, whole, half, whole, whole, whole, half.

Western music is based around the C Major scale because it is the simplest and most commonly used scale. The white keys on a piano represent the notes of the C Major scale, and many popular songs are written in this key. By learning the notes and intervals of the C Major scale, students can easily understand the concepts of scales and key signatures in Western music.

In addition to major scales, there are also minor scales. While major scales have a happy and upbeat sound, minor scales are often associated with sad or melancholic feelings. The pattern for a natural minor scale is: whole, half, whole, whole, half, whole, whole. For example, the A Minor scale consists of the notes A, B, C, D, E, F, and G, with the pattern of whole steps and half steps as follows: whole, half, whole, whole, half, whole, whole.

To fully grasp these concepts, students must understand the key principles of music theory, including:

- Notes and their placement on the musical staff
- Intervals and the distance between two notes
- Scales and the patterns of whole and half steps that form them
- Key signatures and how they represent the notes used in a particular scale or mode
- Chords and how they are built from scales and intervals

To explain these concepts in a clear and concise manner, diagrams and examples can be helpful. For example, a piano keyboard can be used to show the placement of notes and the pattern of whole and half steps in a scale. Examples of popular songs in different keys can also be used to demonstrate the difference between major and minor scales and how they affect the overall mood of a piece of music. By starting with these basic concepts, students can build a strong foundation in music theory and apply their knowledge to their music production using Koala Sampler.

BMT.2 - Blues Scale, Dorian and Phrygian Modes

In this chapter, we will expand upon the basics of music theory covered in Chapter 1 by discussing the Blues Scale and two important modes: Dorian and Phrygian. Understanding these concepts is essential to grasp the foundations of sampling and their use in popular music.

1. The Blues Scale

- Definition: The blues scale is a pentatonic scale consisting of six notes that are used frequently in blues and other genres of music.
- Explanation of the pentatonic scale and how it differs from the major scale
- Demonstration of the blues scale on a keyboard and on a guitar
- Examples of songs that use the blues scale, such as "Stormy Monday" by T-Bone

Walker and "The Thrill Is Gone" by B.B. King

2. The Dorian Mode

- Definition: The Dorian mode is a musical mode that is similar to the natural minor scale, but with a raised sixth degree.
- Explanation of the concept of modes in music theory
- Demonstration of the Dorian mode on a keyboard and on a guitar
- Examples of songs that use the Dorian mode, such as "So What" by Miles Davis and "I Shot the Sheriff" by Bob Marley

3. The Phrygian Mode

- Definition: The Phrygian mode is a musical mode that is similar to the natural minor scale, but with a lowered second degree.
- Demonstration of the Phrygian mode on a keyboard and on a guitar
- Examples of songs that use the Phrygian mode, such as "Enter Sandman" by Metallica and "Maria Maria" by Santana

4. Using extended music theory in sampling and popular music

- Explanation of how understanding these extended music theory concepts can enhance the use of sampling in music production
 - Discussion of how the blues scale, Dorian mode, and Phrygian mode have been used in popular music and sampling, with examples from producers such as J Dilla, Kanye West, and Dr. Dre
- By the end of this chapter, students will have a strong understanding of the blues scale and two important modes in music theory. They will also be able to apply this knowledge to their music production, particularly in the use of sampling.

BMT.3 - Relative and Parallel Keys

Music producers must be able to recognize and work with various keys to create compelling music. Understanding relative and parallel keys is a fundamental concept that is essential for music production.

Relative keys are a pair of keys that have the same key signature but start on different notes. The major and minor scales that share the same key signature are considered relative keys. For example, C major and A minor are relative keys because they both have no sharps or flats in their key signature.

Parallel keys, on the other hand, are a pair of keys that share the same starting note but have different key signatures. The major and minor scales that share the same starting note are considered parallel keys. For example, C major and C minor are parallel keys because they share the same starting note, but have different key signatures.

Understanding relative and parallel keys can greatly increase your efficiency as a producer. Knowing which keys are related can help you quickly find samples that work

well together or adjust a sample to fit in different settings.

Relative and parallel keys are also useful for creating chord progressions. By understanding the relationships between keys, you can create more complex and interesting progressions that take advantage of the emotional impact of each key.

In summary, understanding relative and parallel keys is an important aspect of music theory that every music producer should know. It allows you to quickly find compatible samples, adjust samples to fit different settings, and create more complex and interesting chord progressions.

BMT.4 - Intro to Music Notation and Rhythm

In this chapter, we will introduce the concept of music notation and the music staff. Understanding music notation is essential for communicating musical ideas and for creating clear and concise musical arrangements.

1. The Music Staff
 - Definition and explanation of the music staff
 - Treble and bass clefs
 - Notes and their corresponding positions on the staff
 - Rests and their corresponding positions on the staff
2. Common Key Signatures
 - Introduction to the concept of key signatures
 - Explanation of major and minor key signatures
 - Diagrams of common key signatures
3. 4/4 Time Signature
 - Explanation of time signature
 - Introduction to 4/4 time signature
 - Rhythmic notation in 4/4 time
 - Counting and playing basic rhythms in 4/4 time
4. Understanding Rhythm
 - Definition of rhythm
 - Importance of rhythm in music
 - Explanation of how rhythm is based on feeling and math simultaneously
 - Playing and counting basic rhythms in 4/4 time

This chapter will provide a strong foundation in music notation and rhythm, allowing students to effectively communicate their musical ideas and create clear and cohesive musical arrangements.

BMT.5 - 3/4, 6/8 Time and Basic Drum Sounds

In this chapter, we will dive deeper into music rhythms by introducing the 3/4 and 6/8 time

signatures. We will also explore the basics of drum sounds and how they are used in popular music.

3/4 Time Signature:

The 3/4 time signature is a simple meter with three beats per measure. The quarter note receives one beat in this time signature. It is often used in waltzes and ballads. We will practice counting and clapping along to examples of songs in 3/4 time.

6/8 Time Signature:

The 6/8 time signature is a compound meter with six beats per measure. The eighth note receives one beat in this time signature. It is often used in genres such as soul, reggae, and jazz. We will practice counting and clapping along to examples of songs in 6/8 time.

Basic Drum Sounds

Drums are the backbone of most popular music genres, and it is important for producers to understand the different sounds and their roles in a beat. We will focus on four basic drum sounds: kicks, snares, hi-hats, and toms.

- Kicks: The kick is the most fundamental sound in a beat. It provides the rhythmic foundation for a track and is typically played on the first beat of each measure.
- Snares: The snare provides the "backbeat" in a beat, typically played on the second and fourth beats of each measure. It creates a sense of momentum and helps to drive the track forward.
- Hi-hats: The hi-hat provides a rhythmic texture to a beat, typically played on every eighth note or every other eighth note. It can be used to create different patterns and grooves.
- Toms: Toms are used to create fills and transitions in a beat. They can add variety and excitement to a track.

By understanding the roles of these basic drum sounds, producers can start to build their own beats and create their own rhythms. Later in the course, we will discuss more advanced percussion techniques to further expand your knowledge and skills in drum programming.

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Unit 1 • Component 2
KOALA SAMPLER NAVIGATION
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KSN.1 - SAMPLE TAB

I. Introduction

- Explanation of what the Koala Sampler application is and its purpose
- Overview of the importance of understanding the application

II. Navigating the "Sample" Tab

- Explanation of the "Sample" tab and its functions
 - Overview of the various functions available within the "Sample" tab, including:
 - Sample selection and loading
 - Pitch shifting and time stretching
 - Volume and panning adjustments
 - Playback modes

III. The Drum Pads in Koala

- Introduction to the drum pads within the application
- Overview of the functions of each pad
- Explanation of how the pads can be used to create rhythms and beats

IV. Recording Audio into Koala

- Introduction to recording audio into the application
- Explanation of the recording process
- Overview of the various recording options available within the application

V. Conclusion

- Summary of the key points covered in the chapter
- Overview of how the information covered will be used throughout the course.

KSN.2 - SEQUENCE TAB

I. Overview of the Sequence Tab

- Description of the purpose of the Sequence tab in Koala Sampler
- Explanation of how it differs from the Sample tab

II. Sample Mapping Options

- Overview of the three different sample mapping options: Grid, Keyboard, and Note Repeat views
- Description of each option and its respective functions

III. Transport Functions

- Description of the transport functions available in the Sequence tab, such as Play, Record, and Tempo controls
- Explanation of how to use each function effectively

IV. Editing Sequences

- Step-by-step guide to editing sequences in the Sequence tab, including adding and deleting notes, adjusting note length and velocity, and using the quantize function

V. Saving and Exporting Sequences

- Explanation of how to save sequences within Koala Sampler
- Overview of how to export sequences as audio files

VI. Conclusion

- Summary of the key points covered in the chapter
- Discussion of how understanding the Sequence tab and its functions can enhance music production in Koala Sampler

KSN.3 - PERFORM TAB

I. Introduction

- Brief overview of the Perform tab
- Importance of understanding effects in music production

II. Crush

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

III. Pitch

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

IV. Comb

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

V. Ring

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

VI. Reverb

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

VII. Stutter

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

VIII. Gate

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

IX. Filter

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

X. Cutter

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XI. Reverse

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XII. Dub

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XIII. Tempo Delay

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XIV. Talkbox

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XV. Vibroflange

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XVI. Dirty

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XVII. Compressor

- Explanation of the effect
- Examples of when to use it
- Demonstration of how to use it in Koala Sampler

XVIII. Conclusion

- Recap of effects covered
- Importance of experimentation with effects
- Next steps in learning about music production and effects in Koala Sampler

KSN.4 - STEP SEQUENCER VIEW

I. Introduction

- Brief overview of the chapter's content
- Importance of understanding the Sequencer View in Koala Sampler

II. Overview of the Sequencer View

- Basic layout of the Sequencer View
- Explanation of the timeline and bar divisions
- Description of the different view modes: Piano Roll, Drum Machine, and Step Sequencer

III. Pencil Tool

- Definition and explanation of the Pencil Tool
- How to use the Pencil Tool to create and edit notes
- Tips for using the Pencil Tool effectively

IV. Velocity Tool

- Definition and explanation of the Velocity Tool
- How to use the Velocity Tool to adjust note velocities
- Tips for using the Velocity Tool effectively

V. Probability Tool

- Definition and explanation of the Probability Tool
- How to use the Probability Tool to create random variations in note placement and velocity
- Tips for using the Probability Tool effectively

VI. Piano Roll Functions

- Overview of standard piano roll functions and how they are presented in Koala Sampler
- How to navigate the piano roll interface
- How to adjust note lengths, pitch, and other parameters

VII. Drum Machine Functions

- How to use the Drum Machine view to create drum patterns
- Overview of the available drum sounds and how to edit them
- Tips for creating unique drum patterns in Koala Sampler

VIII. Step Sequencer Functions

- How to use the Step Sequencer view to create patterns using a grid of steps
- Overview of the available sounds and how to edit them
- Tips for using the Step Sequencer effectively

IX. Conclusion

- Recap of the main points covered in the chapter
- Importance of understanding the Sequencer View for creating music in Koala Sampler.

KSN.5 - FILE MANAGEMENT AND AUXILIARY SCREENS

I. Introduction

- Importance of organizing and managing files in Koala Sampler
- Overview of the main menu

II. Setting up User Sample Folders

- How to create a new User Sample Folder
- How to name and locate a User Sample Folder
- Benefits of using User Sample Folders

III. Importing Audio Files

- Options for importing audio files in Koala Sampler
- How to import audio files into Koala Sampler
- Tips for managing imported audio files

IV. Exporting and Saving Projects

- How to save a project in Koala Sampler
- Different file types and their uses
- How to export a project from Koala Sampler

V. Managing Project Backups

- Importance of creating backups
- How to create and manage project backups
- Best practices for project backup management

VI. Deleting and Renaming Files

- How to delete files in Koala Sampler
- How to rename files in Koala Sampler
- Considerations when deleting or renaming files

VII. Conclusion

- Recap of file management practices in Koala Sampler
- Importance of maintaining an organized and efficient workflow

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Unit 2 • Component 1

UNDERSTANDING SAMPLING

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US.1 - SAMPLING AS A PRACTICE

I. Introduction

- Brief explanation of what sampling is and why it's important in popular and hip hop music

II. Early Examples of Sampling

- Explain how Jamaican dub producers in the 1960s and 1970s used tape delays and other effects to create new sounds from existing recordings

III. The Advent of the MPC

- Discuss the release of the Akai MPC in 1988 and its impact on the production of hip hop music

- Explain how the MPC allowed producers to sample and manipulate audio in real time

IV. Interpolating vs. Sampling

- Define interpolation as the process of re-creating a musical idea from scratch
- Define sampling as the process of taking a section of a pre-existing recording and incorporating it into a new composition
- Highlight the legal and ethical issues surrounding sampling, including copyright infringement and fair use

V. Keys and Frequency Ranges

- Explain the importance of understanding musical keys when selecting and manipulating samples
- Discuss how different frequency ranges can affect the timbre and tone of a sample, and how this knowledge can help producers to effectively EQ and process their samples

VI. Conclusion

- Sum up the main points of the chapter and emphasize the importance of understanding the history of sampling in popular and hip hop music, as well as the technical aspects of selecting and manipulating samples.

US.2 - Case Study: 'We Need A Resolution'

I. Introduction

- Overview of the chapter's focus on the sample in "We Need A Resolution"
- Brief background on the artists involved in the production of the song

II. The Sample

- Explanation of the original sample used in "Tricks of the Trade"
- Discussion of how the sample was chopped and arranged in "We Need A Resolution"
- Overview of the pitched-up vocals in the sample and how they were used
- Analysis of the sample's non-traditional melody and how it was incorporated into the song

III. The Production

- Explanation of how the sample serves as the foundation for the track
- Discussion of the various elements added to the song to complement the sample

C. Overview of the song's structure and how it was built around the sample

IV. Timbaland's Techniques

A. Explanation of Timbaland's signature production style

B. Analysis of how he uses sampling as a key element in his productions

C. Discussion of how his techniques were employed in "We Need A Resolution"

V. Conclusion

A. Recap of the importance of sampling in music production

B. Reflection on the impact of "We Need A Resolution" on the music industry

C. Implications for future music production using sampling techniques

VI. Sample Analysis Exercise

A. Detailed walkthrough of an analysis exercise for students to practice sampling techniques

B. Practical application of concepts discussed in the chapter

US.3 - Case Study: 'Through The Wire'

I. Introduction

A. Brief history of sampling in music

B. Importance of the 'Through the Wire' sample

II. Background on 'Through the Fire'

A. Overview of Chaka Khan's career

B. Creation and success of 'Through the Fire'

III. Sampling in 'Through the Wire'

A. How the sample was obtained

B. Chopping and rearranging the sample

C. Pitch-shifting the sample

IV. The role of the sample in 'Through the Wire'

A. Analysis of how the sample is used throughout the song

B. How the sample influences the structure of the song

C. Role of the sample in creating the song's emotional impact

V. Kanye West's sampling technique

A. Overview of Kanye's approach to sampling

B. How he used samples to create his own unique sound

C. Influence on the future of sampling in hip hop

VI. Conclusion

A. Recap of the significance of 'Through the Wire' sample

B. Final thoughts on the impact of Kanye West's sampling technique

VII. References

A. List of sources consulted during research

US.4 - Case Study: 'NY State Of Mind'

I. Introduction

- Brief overview of Nas and DJ Premier's work
- Importance of New York State of Mind in hip-hop music history
- Purpose of the chapter: to analyze the use of multiple samples in the song and how they contribute to the overall sound

II. Background Information on the Song

- Song structure and arrangement
- Use of turntablism as a creative element
- Brief discussion of the lyrical content

III. Sample Analysis

- Sample 1: "Mind Rain" by Joe Chambers
- How the sample is used in the song
- Analysis of its frequency spectrum and how it fits in the mix
- Impact of the sample on the song's mood and atmosphere
- Sample 2: "Flight Time" by Donald Byrd
- How the sample is used in the song
- Analysis of its frequency spectrum and how it fits in the mix
- Impact of the sample on the song's groove and rhythm
- Sample 3: "Smilin' Billy Suite Pt. II" by The Heath Brothers
- How the sample is used in the song
- Analysis of its frequency spectrum and how it fits in the mix

- Impact of the sample on the song's overall texture and musicality

IV. Conclusion

- Recap of the analysis of the samples in the song
- Overall contribution of the samples to the song's success
- Importance of understanding frequency spectrum and sample layering in hip-hop production.

US.5 - Case Study: 'No Problem'

I. Introduction

- Briefly introduce the concept of "Derivative Sampling" and how it differs from traditional sampling.

II. Case study: No Problem by Chance the Rapper, produced by Brasstracks

A. Overview of the song

1. Brief history and background
2. Key elements of the production

B. The practice of "Derivative Sampling"

1. Definition and explanation of the practice
2. How it was used in No Problem

C. Staying true to your voice as a producer

1. Story of Brasstracks' production journey
2. How staying true to their style brought opportunities and success

D. Discussion and analysis of the production

1. Breakdown of the different samples used in the song
2. How they were manipulated and arranged to create the final product

III. Conclusion

- Recap of the key points and takeaways from the chapter.

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Unit 2 • Component 2

Digital Drumming/Drum Design

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D4.1 - DRUM SOUNDS AND ROLES

I. Introduction

- A. Significance of drum sounds in music production
- B. Transition from live drums to digital samples

II. The Translation from Live Drums to Digital Samples

- A. Explanation of the process of sampling live drum sounds
- B. Benefits and challenges of using digital samples in music production

III. Correspondence of Drum Sounds to Live Counterparts

A. Kick Drum

- 1. Role of the kick drum in live drumming
- 2. How the kick drum sound translates to digital samples

B. Snare Drum

- 1. Role of the snare drum in live drumming
- 2. How the snare drum sound translates to digital samples

C. Hi-Hats

- 1. Role of hi-hats in live drumming
- 2. How hi-hat sounds translate to digital samples

D. Toms

- 1. Role of toms in live drumming
- 2. How tom sounds translate to digital samples

E. Cymbals

- 1. Role of cymbals in live drumming
- 2. How cymbal sounds translate to digital samples

IV. Complexity and Layering in Drum Samples

- A. Exploring the versatility of digital samples
- B. How a single drum sample can contain multiple layers of sounds
- C. Advantages of layering drum samples for richer and more dynamic drum sounds

V. Blurring Roles and Creativity with Drum Samples

- A. How drum samples can blur the traditional roles of drum sounds

- B. Creative use of drum samples to create unique rhythms and textures
- C. Examples of how digital samples have expanded the possibilities of drum programming

VI. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the main points discussed in the chapter
- B. Emphasis on the adaptability and creative potential of drum samples in music production.

D4.2 - BUILDING PATTERNS

I. Introduction

- A. Importance of drum patterns in shaping the groove of a song
- B. The role of a producer in directing the feel and vibe of a beat

II. Combining Drum Samples for Basic Rhythms

- A. Explanation of how drum patterns are created by combining different drum samples
- B. Discussion of the relationship between kick, snare, hi-hat, and other drum sounds
- C. Examples of common drum patterns and their impact on the feel of a beat

III. Shaping the Groove

- A. Understanding the concept of "groove" in music
- B. How drum patterns contribute to the overall groove of a song
- C. The producer's role in determining the desired groove and feel

IV. Directing Workflow with a Groove in Mind

- A. The benefits of having a rough idea of the desired groove before starting production
- B. How a clear groove concept can guide decision-making during production
- C. Tips for staying focused and achieving the intended vibe in the beat

V. Balancing Realism and Creativity

- A. Discussion of the concept of "realism" in digital drumming
- B. How digital drumming allows for creative manipulation and experimentation
- C. Finding the right balance between a realistic drum sound and creative expression

VI. Incorporating Human Touch

- A. Techniques for adding subtle variations and imperfections to digital drum patterns
- B. The impact of humanizing drum patterns on the overall feel and vibe
- C. Examples of using velocity adjustments, swing, and randomization to add human touch

VII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the main points discussed in the chapter
- B. Emphasis on the producer's role in crafting the groove and feel of a beat through drum patterns.

D4.3 - UNDERSTANDING SWING

I. Introduction

- A. Explanation of the concept of "swing" in music
- B. Importance of swing in shaping the rhythm and feel of a composition

II. Swing in Jazz

- A. Origins and characteristics of swing jazz
- B. Description of the pushed 8th note feeling in swing jazz
- C. How swing contributes to the groove and energy of jazz music

III. Swing in Digital Music Production

- A. Adapting swing to digital music production
- B. Explanation of how swing is applied to digital drum patterns
- C. Examples of digital swing and its impact on rhythm and groove

IV. Nuances of Digital Swing

- A. Manipulating swing to retain the original "feel" of a sample
- B. Balancing swing with quantization for a humanized yet structured rhythm
- C. Techniques for adjusting swing intensity to match the desired vibe

V. Avoiding Robotic Feel

- A. Explanation of how excessive quantization can result in a robotic rhythm
- B. How swing can add natural variations and imperfections
- C. Examples of applying swing to prevent robotic-sounding patterns

VI. Creative Applications of Swing

- A. Using swing to create unique and unexpected rhythms
- B. How swing can influence the overall mood and character of a track
- C. Experimentation with swing to add complexity and depth to digital drum patterns

VII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of swing's significance in music and digital production
- B. Emphasis on the art of applying swing to enhance rhythm, groove, and musicality.

D4.4 - NOTE REPEAT

I. Introduction

- A. Explanation of the note repeat function in music production
- B. Significance of note repeat in shaping rhythmic patterns and textures

II. Note Repeat in Drum Sequences and DAWs

- A. Overview of the note repeat feature available in various drum machines and DAWs
- B. How note repeat works and its role in creating rhythmic patterns
- C. Benefits and creative possibilities of using note repeat

III. Hi-Hat Rolls in Trap Music

- A. Emergence of hi-hat rolls as a signature element in trap music
- B. How note repeat is used to create rapid and rhythmic hi-hat patterns
- C. Examples of famous trap tracks with prominent hi-hat rolls

IV. Beyond Hi-Hats: Note Repeat on Different Sounds

- A. Exploration of note repeat's application to various sounds beyond hi-hats
- B. Examples of using note repeat on percussion, melodic elements, and vocal samples
- C. Diversification of rhythms and textures through note repeat on different sounds

V. Note Repeat's Influence on Hip Hop and Popular Genres

- A. Discussion of note repeat's impact on the evolution of hip hop production
- B. How note repeat contributes to the distinct sound of modern hip hop and related genres
- C. Blurring genre boundaries through innovative use of note repeat

VI. Creative Manipulation and Experimentation

- A. Techniques for altering note repeat parameters to create unique effects
- B. How note repeat can be combined with other production tools for enhanced creativity
- C. Pushing the boundaries of note repeat for experimental and unconventional rhythms

VII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the versatility and significance of note repeat in contemporary music production
- B. Encouragement for producers to explore and experiment with note repeat to shape their own unique sound.

D4.5 - DRUM FX/PROCESSING

I. Introduction

- A. Explanation of the role of audio effects in manipulating drum sounds
- B. Significance of using effects to shape the character and impact of drum and percussion elements

II. Enhancing Creativity through Effects

- A. Introduction to the creative potential of adding effects to drums
- B. How effects can inspire new sonic ideas and directions in music production
- C. Role of effects in developing a unique and recognizable producer's signature sound

III. Sonic Exploration with Drum Effects

- A. Techniques for applying effects to drums to achieve unique textures and tones
- B. Examples of using effects to transform traditional drum sounds into innovative sonic elements
- C. Encouragement for experimentation and thinking outside the box with drum effects

IV. Managing Loudness and the Role of Effects

- A. Discussion of the loudness wars in music production
- B. How effect processing can contribute to perceived loudness in a mix
- C. Strategies for using effects to achieve a balanced and dynamic drum sound

V. Stages of Production and Drum Processing

- A. Explanation of how drum processing needs vary in different stages of production
- B. Pre-production: Crafting drum sounds and timbres
- C. Mixing and Mastering: Polishing and refining drum elements for the final mix

VI. Applying Effects to Different Drum Elements

- A. Kick Drum: Enhancing punch, depth, and presence
- B. Snare Drum: Adding character, body, and spatial effects
- C. Hi-Hats and Cymbals: Shaping tonality, space, and sparkle
- D. Toms and Percussion: Creating depth, width, and texture

VII. Balancing Effects and Musicality

- A. Importance of maintaining the musicality and groove of drum elements
- B. Using effects to enhance, not overshadow, the core rhythm and feel
- C. Tips for achieving a balanced blend of processed and natural drum sounds

VIII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the dual role of drum effects: creative exploration and sonic enhancement
- B. Encouragement for producers to master the art of drum effects processing to craft distinctive and impactful drum elements.

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Unit 3 • Component 1

SONG FORMS IN POP

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SONGFORM.1 - INTRO TO SONG FORM

I. Introduction

- A. Definition of song form and its importance in music composition
- B. Overview of the role of song form in shaping the listener's experience

II. Evolution of Song Form in Popular Music

- A. Historical context of traditional song forms (e.g., AABA, verse-chorus)
- B. Influence of Jazz on breaking traditional song structure norms
- C. Impact of R&B and its experimentation with song forms
- D. Contribution of The Beatles and other artists to the diversification of song structures

III. The Changing Landscape of Popularity and Form

- A. Explanation of how song form's correlation with popularity has evolved
- B. Shift from formulaic song structures to more experimental and unique forms
- C. Examples of popular songs with unconventional forms that have achieved success

IV. Embracing Diversity in Song Forms

- A. Encouragement for artists to explore diverse song structures
- B. How non-traditional song forms contribute to musical innovation and uniqueness
- C. Importance of balancing familiarity with creativity in songwriting

V. Analyzing Song Form

- A. Overview of common song sections (verse, chorus, bridge, etc.)
- B. Explanation of how songwriters use repetition, contrast, and variation in form
- C. How song form affects the listener's emotional journey through a composition

VI. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the role of song form in shaping the landscape of popular music
- B. Acknowledgment of the artists who have pushed boundaries and expanded the possibilities of song structures
- C. Encouragement for musicians to embrace creativity and diversity in their songwriting while understanding the impact of form on the listener's experience.

SONGFORM.2 - AABA AND SIMPLE VARIATIONS

I. Introduction

- A. Explanation of AABA song form and its structure
- B. Significance of AABA form in shaping many popular songs

II. AABA Form: Origins and Popularization

- A. Historical context of AABA form's emergence in popular music
- B. How AABA form became a staple in early 20th-century popular songs
- C. Influence of Tin Pan Alley and Broadway musicals on popularizing AABA form

III. AABA Form as a Starting Point for Musical Subversion

- A. Acknowledgment of musical subversion throughout history
- B. How AABA form's popularity wouldn't necessarily mark the beginning of musical subversion
- C. Examples of early instances of breaking out of traditional forms

IV. Minor Variations of AABA Form

- A. Introduction of minor variations that still adhere to the AABA structure
- B. Discussing the importance of small modifications to maintain listener engagement
- C. How slight changes in rhythm, melody, or phrasing can create variation within the form

V. Subtle Creative Shifts within AABA Form

- A. Discussion of harmonic variations within the AABA structure
- B. Exploring how dynamic changes, instrumentation, and arrangement contribute to variation
- C. Examples of songs with nuanced alterations that still fit the AABA framework

VI. Beyond AABA: Expanding the Concept

- A. Exploration of AABA-based forms in different genres and cultural contexts
- B. How AABA has influenced and evolved into more complex song structures
- C. Encouragement for songwriters to experiment with variations and extensions of AABA

VII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the AABA song form and its historical significance
- B. Acknowledgment of the continuous evolution of musical forms
- C. Encouragement for artists to embrace the flexibility of AABA form while exploring new creative possibilities.

SONGFORM.3 - Case Study: 'Sicko Mode'

I. Introduction

- A. Brief overview of the song "Sicko Mode" by Travis Scott featuring Drake
- B. Significance of the song's unique structure and its impact on modern music

II. Understanding the Song Form

- A. Overview of the song's unconventional structure
- B. Explanation of the concept of a "beat flip" and its role in the song
- C. Discussion of the multi-part arrangement that breaks away from traditional song forms

III. Analyzing the Beat Flip

- A. Explanation of the transition between different beats and sections
- B. How the beat flip adds dynamic shifts and keeps the listener engaged
- C. Role of beat flips in creating distinct musical sections within the song

IV. Contrasting Drake's Verses

- A. Examination of the differences between Drake's two verses
- B. How each verse contributes to the narrative and mood of the song
- C. Role of Drake's vocal delivery in adding variety and depth to the song

V. Internal Structure of Each Section

- A. Analysis of the structure within each part of the song
- B. Breakdown of the instrumentation, rhythm, and melodic elements
- C. How transitions and sonic changes contribute to the overall song's progression

VI. Creative Use of Sonic Variation

- A. Discussion of the song's sonic diversity and its impact on the listener
- B. Exploration of how sound design choices contribute to the song's unique character
- C. Examples of how contrasting sonic elements create a captivating listening experience

VII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the analysis of "Sicko Mode" and its unconventional structure
- B. Acknowledgment of Travis Scott's and Drake's creative contributions to the song
- C. Encouragement for artists to draw inspiration from unique song structures to push the boundaries of their own creativity.

SONGFORM.4 - Case Study: 'Self Control'

I. Introduction

- A. Brief overview of the song "Self Control" by Frank Ocean
- B. Significance of the song's layered structure and its impact on the listener's experience

II. Understanding the Song Form

- A. Overview of the song's progression and structure
- B. Discussion of how the song evolves over time through various sections

III. Layered Composition

- A. Analysis of the layers of instrumentation and vocals in the song
- B. How each layer contributes to the song's emotional depth and complexity
- C. Role of layered composition in creating a rich and immersive sonic experience

IV. Progression and Transition

- A. Breakdown of how the song progresses through different sections
- B. Explanation of how transitions between sections are achieved
- C. How the song's pacing and transitions contribute to its overall narrative

V. Varied Use of Electric Guitar

- A. Examination of the electric guitar's role in differentiating song sections
- B. Analysis of how the guitar's timbre and playing style change to signify shifts
- C. How the guitar's sonic variation adds texture and emotion to the song

VI. Emotional Resonance and Storytelling

- A. Exploration of how the song's layers and progression enhance its emotional resonance
- B. Discussion of how the composition style supports the song's storytelling
- C. How shifts in instrumentation and dynamics mirror the song's themes and emotions

VII. Creative Sound Design and Sonic Palette

- A. Analysis of the use of sound effects and electronic elements
- B. How the song's sonic palette creates a dreamy and ethereal atmosphere

C. Role of creative sound design in shaping the song's overall ambiance

VIII. Conclusion

A. Recap of the analysis of "Self Control" and its layered structure

B. Acknowledgment of Frank Ocean's artistic choices and their impact on the song

C. Encouragement for artists to explore layered composition and sonic variation to enhance the depth and impact of their own music.

SONGFORM.5 - BEAT FLIPS/TRANSITIONS

I. Introduction

A. Recap of the concept of a beat flip and its significance in modern music

B. Overview of the chapter's exploration into various examples and comparisons

II. Exploring Beat Flips Across Genres

A. Discussion of beat flips in hip-hop, electronic, pop, and other genres

B. Examples of notable beat flips that have reshaped the trajectory of songs

C. How beat flips contribute to genre-blending and the evolution of musical styles

III. Modern Beat Flips and Classical Compositions

A. Comparison between modern beat flips and compositional movements in classical music

B. Exploration of how abrupt shifts and transitions are used in both contexts

C. Examples of classical compositions that employ dramatic shifts and transformations

IV. Beat Flips as Dynamic Storytelling

A. How beat flips enhance the storytelling aspect of a song

B. Discussion of how transitions can mirror changes in emotion, narrative, or atmosphere

C. Role of beat flips in keeping the listener engaged and intrigued

V. Sonic Variety and Texture

A. Exploration of how beat flips contribute to a song's sonic diversity and texture

B. Discussion of how contrasting elements in different sections create interest

C. Examples of songs that use beat flips to create dynamic contrast and sonic depth

VI. Rhythmic Innovation and Evolution

A. How beat flips push the boundaries of rhythm and meter

B. Exploration of how beat flips contribute to rhythmic innovation and evolution

C. Comparison of rhythmic experimentation in beat flips to historical shifts in rhythm

VII. Influence on Music Production Trends

- A. Discussion of how beat flips have influenced contemporary music production
- B. How beat flips contribute to the cyclical nature of music trends and movements
- C. Examples of how beat flips have inspired new creative directions in music

VIII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the exploration of beat flips and transitions in music
- B. Acknowledgment of the role of beat flips in shaping modern musical landscapes
- C. Encouragement for artists to draw inspiration from beat flips and transitions to infuse their own music with creativity and intrigue.

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Unit 3 • Component 2

SAMPLING RIGHTS AND PERMISSIONS

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SRP.1 - ETHICAL USE OF SAMPLING

I. Introduction

- A. Explanation of the concept of musical sampling in modern music production
- B. Significance of ethical considerations in the sampling process

II. Defining Musical Sampling

- A. Modern definition of musical sampling as the use of pre-existing recordings in new compositions
- B. Clarification of the difference between a musical work sample and an individual sound sample

III. Ethical Sampling: Navigating Ownership and Rights

- A. Importance of understanding ownership and rights of sampled material
- B. Discussion of the ethical implications of using samples without proper permission or clearance
- C. Role of sampling in composition, songwriting, and publishing

IV. The Impact of Unethical Sampling

- A. Exploration of legal and financial consequences of unauthorized or unethical sampling
- B. How unethical sampling can damage the reputation and credibility of artists

V. The Art of Ethical Sampling

- A. Discussion of what it means to sample ethically and responsibly
- B. Importance of obtaining proper clearances and licenses for sampled material
- C. Role of attribution and giving credit to original creators

VI. Navigating Complex Ownership Structures

- A. Exploration of the complexity of ownership in musical works
- B. Discussion of how various elements (lyrics, melodies, arrangements) can have different rights holders
- C. Importance of conducting thorough research to identify and contact rights holders

VII. Collaborative Sampling: Building Relationships

- A. How collaboration with original creators can enhance the sampling process
- B. Examples of successful collaborations between producers and original artists
- C. Importance of open communication and negotiation in collaborative sampling

VIII. Educating and Empowering Producers

- A. Discussion of the role of education in promoting ethical sampling practices
- B. Importance of educating emerging producers about sampling rights and clearances
- C. Encouragement for producers to take responsibility and make informed decisions when sampling

IX. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the importance of ethical sampling in music production
- B. Acknowledgment of the complex landscape of ownership and rights in sampling
- C. Preview of upcoming chapters that delve further into topics related to composition, songwriting, and publishing.

SRP.2 - SONG OWNERSHIP PUBLISHING/SONGWRITING

I. Introduction

- A. Overview of the breakdown of song ownership and the importance of understanding it
- B. Significance of song ownership in the modern music industry landscape

II. Composition vs. Publishing Ownership

- A. Explanation of the distinction between composition and publishing rights
- B. Discussion of how ownership is divided between the creators of lyrics and melodies

III. The Role of Performing Rights Organizations (PROs)

- A. Explanation of PROs and their function in collecting performance royalties
- B. Discussion of how PROs monitor and collect royalties from public performances

IV. Navigating Digital Streaming Platforms (DSPs)

- A. Introduction to DSPs and their role in music distribution
- B. Explanation of how royalties are generated and collected from streaming platforms
- C. Importance of understanding digital streaming revenue for song ownership and publishing

V. The Role of Distributors in Modern Music Industry

- A. Explanation of the role of distributors like CD Baby, United Masters, etc.
- B. Discussion of how distributors facilitate the release and monetization of music
- C. Importance of choosing the right distributor to maximize earnings and control

VI. Publishing Administration and Collection

- A. Exploration of the role of publishing administrators in royalty collection
- B. Explanation of how publishing administrators ensure proper distribution of publishing royalties
- C. Importance of efficient publishing administration for accurate and timely royalty payments

VII. Songwriting Splits and Agreements

- A. Discussion of the importance of clear songwriting splits among collaborators
- B. Explanation of how songwriting agreements define ownership percentages
- C. Importance of transparent communication and documentation to avoid disputes

VIII. Importance of Accurate Metadata

- A. Explanation of metadata and its role in proper royalty distribution
- B. How accurate metadata ensures proper identification and tracking of compositions
- C. Importance of maintaining metadata integrity for fair compensation

IX. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the breakdown of song ownership and publishing
- B. Acknowledgment of the crucial role of understanding ownership and rights for artists
- C. Encouragement for artists to educate themselves about these concepts to make informed decisions and maximize their earnings in the music industry.

SRP.3 - OBTAINING PERMISSION

I. Introduction

- A. Overview of the importance of obtaining permission to use samples in music production
- B. Significance of understanding the distinction between sync permissions and sample permissions

II. Sample Permissions: Navigating the Process

- A. Explanation of the process of obtaining sample permissions
- B. Discussion of the importance of identifying and contacting rights holders
- C. Role of sample clearance and licensing in legally using existing recordings

III. Sync Permissions: Exploring the World of Synchronization

- A. Introduction to sync permissions and their relation to visual media
- B. Explanation of how sync permissions are obtained for film, TV, advertisements, and more
- C. Importance of understanding the scope and usage of the synchronization license

IV. Sync Agencies: Facilitating Licensing and Clearance

- A. Explanation of sync agencies and their role in facilitating sync licensing
- B. Discussion of a well-known sync agency example (e.g., BMI, ASCAP, SESAC)
- C. How sync agencies streamline the process of obtaining sync permissions

V. Creative Alternatives and Bending the Rules

- A. Discussion of the concept of bending rules for creative purposes
- B. Exploring the practice of DJ-style remixing and mashups without full permission
- C. Ethical considerations when using samples in a transformative and original manner

VI. Fair Use and Transformative Use

- A. Explanation of fair use and its relevance to sampling and remixing
- B. Discussion of the transformative use doctrine and its impact on sample legality
- C. Importance of understanding the legal boundaries of fair use and transformative use

VII. Remix Culture and Transformation

- A. Exploration of the evolution of remix culture and its influence on music production
- B. Examples of transformative works that have reshaped the boundaries of copyright
- C. How transformative works contribute to artistic expression and innovation

VIII. Navigating Uncertainty and Emerging Trends

- A. Discussion of the challenges and uncertainties in obtaining permission for samples
- B. Exploration of emerging trends in sample clearance and licensing
- C. Importance of staying informed about evolving legal and industry practices

IX. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the process of obtaining permission for samples and sync licensing
- B. Acknowledgment of the importance of legal and ethical considerations in music production
- C. Encouragement for artists to navigate the complexities of sample clearance while fostering creative innovation and artistic expression.

SRP.4 - GRAY AREAS AND NON COPY-WRITTEN MATERIAL

I. Introduction

- A. Acknowledgment of the complexities and uncertainties in navigating copyright and permissions
- B. Overview of the chapter's focus on best practices for handling non-copyrighted material

II. The Reality of Gray Areas

- A. Discussion of the inherent gray areas and exceptions in copyright and permissions
- B. Exploration of cases where clear ownership and permissions are difficult to determine

III. Learning from Mistakes and Losses

- A. Importance of acknowledging mistakes and losses in the sampling and licensing process
- B. Discussion of how learning from mistakes contributes to professional growth

IV. Documenting Non-Copyrighted Material

- A. Explanation of the significance of proper documentation for non-copyrighted material
- B. Discussion of best practices for keeping records of sources and creators

V. Maintaining Transparent Records

- A. Importance of maintaining a detailed record of where non-copyrighted material is gathered from
- B. Discussion of how clear documentation can prevent disputes and confusion in the future

VI. Crediting Original Creators

- A. Exploration of the importance of giving credit to original creators of non-copyrighted material
- B. Discussion of how proper crediting contributes to a respectful and collaborative creative community

VII. Collaborative Ethos and Integrity

- A. How maintaining integrity in documenting and crediting non-copyrighted material builds trust
- B. Discussion of the role of collaboration in ensuring accurate representation of creative contributions

VIII. Incorporating Non-Copyrighted Material Responsibly

- A. Exploration of the creative potential of non-copyrighted material
- B. Discussion of ethical considerations when using non-copyrighted material in compositions

IX. Embracing Uncertainty and Continual Learning

- A. Importance of embracing the ever-evolving landscape of copyright and permissions
- B. Discussion of the role of ongoing education and adaptation in a changing industry

X. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the chapter's focus on gray areas, non-copyrighted material, and best practices
- B. Acknowledgment of the complexities of documentation and crediting
- C. Encouragement for artists to approach non-copyrighted material with transparency, respect, and a commitment to ethical and responsible creative practices.

SRP.5 - Case Study: Ed Sheeran vs Xscape and Robin Thicke vs Marvin Gaye Estate

I. Introduction

- A. Overview of the significance of copyright infringement cases in the music industry
- B. Explanation of the purpose of the case studies and their relevance to sampling and copyright

II. Case Study: Ed Sheeran vs Xscape

- A. Background of the copyright infringement lawsuit involving Ed Sheeran's song and Xscape's song
- B. Exploration of the disputed elements and similarities between the two songs
- C. Discussion of the legal and ethical considerations surrounding this case

III. Analyzing Song Elements and Ownership

- A. Examination of the compositional and melodic aspects of the two songs
- B. Discussion of the importance of identifying ownership and rights in such cases
- C. Role of songwriting splits and documentation in determining copyright infringement

IV. Case Study: Robin Thicke vs Marvin Gaye Estate

- A. Background of the copyright infringement lawsuit involving Robin Thicke's song and Marvin Gaye's song
- B. Exploration of the alleged similarities and disputed elements between the two songs
- C. Discussion of the legal proceedings, verdict, and implications of this case

V. Ethical Sampling and Creative Intent

- A. Examination of the concept of ethical sampling in light of these case studies

- B. Discussion of how creative intent and transformative use play a role in legal considerations
- C. Importance of understanding the boundaries of ethical sampling to avoid copyright disputes

VI. Implications for Music Production and Composition

- A. How these case studies impact music producers and composers
- B. Discussion of the role of awareness, education, and diligence in sampling practices
- C. Importance of learning from these cases to make informed and ethical creative decisions

VII. Copyright Education and Industry Shifts

- A. Exploration of how copyright education has evolved in the music industry
- B. Discussion of how these cases have influenced shifts in sampling practices and regulations
- C. Importance of staying updated on copyright laws and industry changes

VIII. Conclusion

- A. Recap of the case studies of Ed Sheeran vs Xscape and Robin Thicke vs Marvin Gaye Estate
- B. Acknowledgment of the lessons and insights gained from these cases
- C. Encouragement for artists to approach sampling with a thorough understanding of ownership, ethical considerations, and the potential legal implications.

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Unit 4 • Component 1

DEFINING YOUR SOUND // APPLIED THEORY

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DYS.1 - HONING A SOUND... YOUR SOUND

DYS.2 - PLAYLIST ACTIVITY

DYS.3 - PLAYLIST ANALYSIS

DYS.4 - PLAYLIST ANALYSIS

DYS.5 - REVIEW WEEK

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Unit 4 • Component 2

ARTIST APPRECIATION WEEK

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AW.1 - FINAL PROJECT SONG SELECTION

AW.2 - FP CLASS PROPOSALS AND DISCUSSION

AW.3 - FP WORK WEEK

AW.4 - FP WORK WEEK

AW.5 -

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Unit 5 • Component 1

ADVANCED EFFECTS PROCESSING

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AEP.1 - PERFORM TAB.II

AEP.2 - EXPANDING IDEAS IN SEQUENCING WITH FX

AEP.3 - 1:1's FOLLOW UP ON FP'S

AEP.4 - KOALA VS OTHER MOBILE DAWS

AEP.5 -

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Unit 5 • Component 2

PERFORMING WITH KOALA SAMPLER

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PERFORMANCE.1 - FINAL PROJECT

PERFORMANCE.2 - PERFORMANCE CHECK IN

PERFORMANCE.3 - LIVE RECORDING

PERFORMANCE.4 - CLASS PRESENTATIONS

PERFORMANCE.5 - CLASS PRESENTATIONS

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Who can teach this course?

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The ideal teacher for the Koalacademy curriculum would have a deep passion for music and be highly skilled in analyzing music at a detailed level. They should have a degree in music, audio engineering, live sound or a related field, with experience using at least one of the major DAWs, such as Logic Pro, Ableton Live or Pro Tools. Additionally, experience with iOS DAWs, such as Koala Sampler, Loopy Pro or Beatmaker, would be a plus.

The teacher should have a strong foundation in music theory, including the ability to play intermediate level chords and scales on a piano. They should have a natural ability to teach complex musical concepts in an accessible way to students of all levels.

Above all, the ideal teacher for Koalacademy should have a genuine desire to help students unlock their musical potential. They should be patient, encouraging, and willing to invest time and energy into each student to help them achieve their goals. With these skills and qualities, the teacher will be able to inspire and empower their students to excel in the world of music production.

Make GPT account

YT ownership landing point for students music

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The Apps

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while koala sampler and other mobile DAWs can be great foundations, they are not themselves educational tools. in order to radically upset the landscape of musical education, this course/ curriculum calls for its own medium and applications. the following two apps will leverage the popularity of music production as a hobby and career as well as the constant need for accessibility in these same areas.

in school I could understand almost any musical concept and play or recognize it by ear. but I greatly struggled with sight reading. I often joked to myself about one classmate who stated they had “pitch dyslexia” in aural skills when it came to singing back the note our teacher played, which to me sounded like he may not have practiced enough or maybe just didn’t have an ear... but who am I to say whether or not such a condition exists? but recently that also made me think, what about “notation dyslexia”? if musical notation is the equivalent of written sentences, couldn’t someone (me?) struggle visually with mixing up the notes on the staff?

these questions and admittances of preemptive judgment (maybe pitch dyslexia does exist) are the genesis to Blooprint: Production and Blooprint: Notation

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Blooprint: Production

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(two o’s stylized as infinity for branding?)

Objective:

To teach common practices in digital audio workstations through gamification, enabling users to develop transferable skills applicable across different workstations.

Features:

1. Gamification:

- Incorporates game elements to teach skills like reverb, delay, and drum programming.
 - Users progress through the game, creating parts that combine to form complete songs.
2. Integration with Ableton:
 - Highly integrated with Ableton using Ableton Link.
 - Provides a practical understanding of how features work in Ableton.
 3. Duolingo-style Interface:
 - Utilizes a Duolingo-style application interface for an engaging learning experience.
 - Focuses on interactive lessons and practical application.

Technical Aspects:

1. Ableton Link Integration:
 - Seamless integration with Ableton for a hands-on experience.
 - Allows users to apply skills learned directly in the Ableton environment.
2. Game Components:
 - Incorporates interactive game components for teaching various skills.
 - User progress tracked through the creation of track parts.
3. Transferable Skills:
 - Aims for users to develop skills applicable to different digital audio workstations.

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Blooprint: Notation

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Objective:

An accessibility app designed for individuals with reading disabilities or challenges with traditional music notation, using interactive games to teach music theory.

Features:

1. Accessibility Focus:
 - Tailored for individuals with reading disabilities.
 - Utilizes interactive games for a more engaging learning experience.
2. Microphone Integration:

- Uses the microphone for playback and immediate feedback when users play a sequence of notes.
 - Enhances the interactive and dynamic learning experience.
3. Theory Component:
- Incorporates a theory component to enhance the user’s understanding of music notation.
 - Progresses as users advance through the application.

Technical Aspects:

1. React (or other popular app framework) Format:
 - Utilizes React for the development of components, including staff and note components.
 - Ensures a structured and efficient development process.
2. Interactive Elements:
 - Implements interactive animations for notes, providing visual feedback.
 - Enhances the accessibility of music education for diverse learners.
 - Notes include attributes and functions indicating correct or incorrect completion.

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Blooprint: Community

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